

TravAID — Change a Spare Tyre

Duration: 20–30 min • Difficulty: Easy

Safety: Park on level ground. Turn on hazard lights. Never get under a car held only by a jack.

Step 1. Secure the vehicle

Engage handbrake. Put car in 1st gear (or Park). Place wheel chocks or stones behind the wheel diagonally opposite the flat tyre.

Step 2. Loosen the wheel nuts

Use the wheel wrench to loosen (counter-clockwise) each nut by about half a turn while the tyre is still on the ground. Do not remove yet.

Step 3. Position the jack

Locate the manufacturer's jacking point on the chassis nearest the flat tyre. Raise the car until the tyre is ~5cm off the ground.

Step 4. Remove the flat

Fully unscrew the nuts and pull the wheel straight off. Place it under the car as a safety backup.

Step 5. Mount the spare

Lift the spare onto the hub. Hand-tighten the nuts in a star pattern.

Step 6. Lower and final-tighten

Lower the car. Tighten the nuts firmly in a star pattern using your body weight on the wrench. Do not exceed manufacturer torque.

Step 7. Wrap up

Stow the flat tyre, jack, and tools. Drive to a tyre shop within 80 km if using a 'space saver' spare — max 80 km/h.